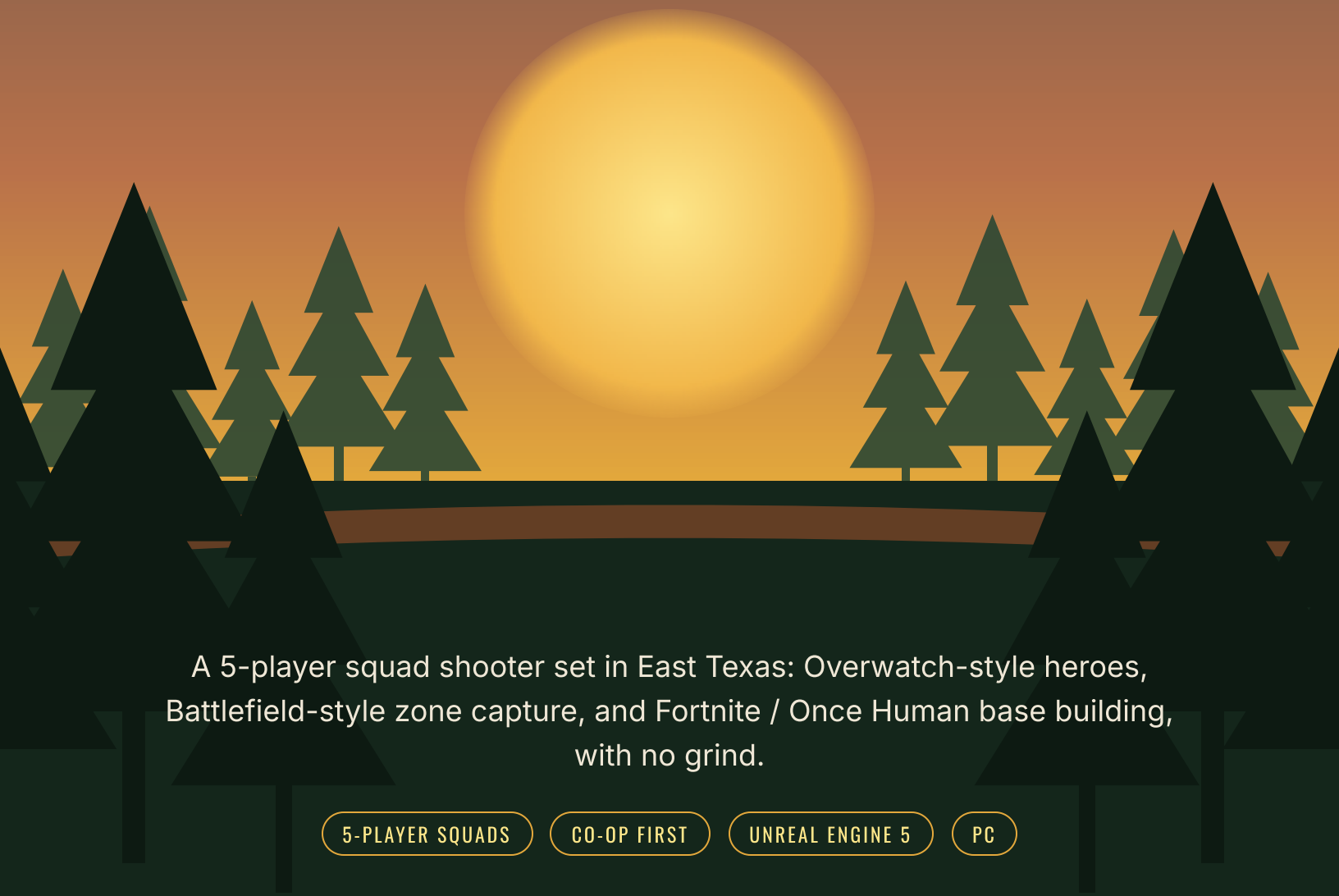
A GAME PITCH

PINEY WOODS

TIMBER WARS



A 5-player squad shooter set in East Texas: Overwatch-style heroes, Battlefield-style zone capture, and Fortnite / Once Human base building, with no grind.

5-PLAYER SQUADS · CO-OP FIRST · UNREAL ENGINE 5 · PC

WORKING TITLE · OCTOBER 19, 2026

01 THE PITCH

Your squad of five drops into an East Texas map with a starter base. Some of you fortify and chop pines; the rest push out to capture sub-bases that unlock planes, armories and backup. Win by blowing up the enemy HQ.

No grind. Every hero and build is unlocked from day one, so the only thing you grind for is the win. Working title; everything here is open for debate.

INSPIRATION	WHAT WE TAKE FROM IT
Overwatch	Heroes with abilities and ultimates; team roles
Battlefield	Zone capture and tickets (a shared pool of lives)
Warzone	Big maps, dropping in, tension when lives run out
Fortnite	Building in the middle of a fight; style and humor
Once Human	Base building, upgrading with materials, a base that persists
Call of Duty modes	Search & Destroy, Domination and Push, combined into one mode

02 HOW A MATCH PLAYS: CONQUEST

One mode combines Domination (hold zones), Push (attack and counterattack) and Search & Destroy (plant a charge to win). Each side has a home base, and 3–5 sub-bases sit between them.

1 · FORTIFY

You land with a starter HQ, walls and a turret. Builders chop pines, gather scrap, set booby traps and build defenses.

2 · SCOUT & CAPTURE

The rest of the squad pushes out to take sub-bases. Each one unlocks an advantage and a closer respawn point. A natural split is 2 builders and 3 attackers.

3 · HOLD THE LINE

The enemy pushes to retake sub-bases and raids your home base, so you keep choosing between pushing forward and defending.

4 · WIN

Plant a demolition charge on the enemy HQ and defend it while it arms; they can defuse it. A sneak attack can win without taking every sub-base. The sub-bases just make it much easier.

In co-op, an AI squad plays the other side by the same rules: it fortifies, captures, flies the plane and comes for your HQ. For PvP later, five real players replace the AI and nothing else changes.

03 EXAMPLE MAP: ETR AIRPORT

FIVE SUB-BASES SIT BETWEEN THE TWO HQs



The Runway in the center is the big prize. Every sub-base helps, but none is required to win.

SUB-BASE	CAPTURING IT UNLOCKS
The Runway (center)	A small 2-seat plane: one pilot, one dropping munitions
Hangar A and Hangar B	Armories that upgrade your squad's weapons a tier
Control Tower	Radar that shows enemies on your minimap
Cargo Terminal	Hometown Heroes to station at your bases

The plane needs counters so it can't take over a match: a buildable anti-aircraft turret, a fragile airframe and a cooldown on munitions.

04 LIVES AND TICKETS

Respawns are free for roughly the first 10 minutes while you set up. After that, the squad shares a pool of tickets, about 15 to start: each death costs one, and capturing a sub-base earns some back.

Out of tickets means last lives. That's where the **"get beat, then barely pull it off"** moments come from.

05 HEROES

Five starting heroes, using Overwatch's key layout. Builder heroes shine at home; assault heroes shine on the push.

Ranger — DAMAGE

- SHIFT Dash
- E Frag Grenade
- Q · ULT **Hog Wild:** double fire rate, no reloads

Lumberjack — TANK

- SHIFT Bark Barrier
- E Axe Charge
- Q · ULT **TIMBER!:** ground slam that fells nearby pines for lumber

Doc — SUPPORT

- SHIFT Heal Pulse
- E Adrenaline
- Q · ULT **Second Wind:** team heal, and revives fallen teammates

Hawk — RECON / SNIPER

- SHIFT Jump Pack
- E Recon Dart
- Q · ULT **Airstrike**

Engineer — BUILDER

SHIFT Mini Sentry · E Repair Pulse · Q · ULT **Fortify:** your structures can't be damaged

06 BASE BUILDING & HOMETOWN HEROES

No 100 hours of looting for one base. You start with an HQ and a few defenses and add to them during the match: chop pines for lumber, open supply crates for scrap. The menu covers log walls, sentry turrets, campfires that heal, barbed wire, booby traps and HQ upgrades.



Hometown Heroes

Hillbillies in overalls who hold one spot (a porch, a truck bed, a deer stand) and shoot at anything that comes close. They're low on health, but they waste the enemy's time and attention and give away where attackers are. They can't capture zones, and each base holds about 4. Enemy sub-bases come with their own.

07 MAPS

Three real East Texas places, each with a different kind of terrain so they don't play alike. Pine Harbor comes first.

Pine Harbor

FIRST

Lake O' the Pines

Setting: lakeshore, marinas, docks, dense pines, cabins.

Plays like: boats, bases on islands and docks, forest ambushes; the most "chop and build" map.

Longview

City map

Setting: downtown streets, rooftops, rail yard, oil field.

Plays like: vertical fights, fortifying buildings, lots of scrap.

ETR Airport

East Texas Regional

Setting: runways, hangars, control tower, open fields.

Plays like: long sightlines, vehicles, the plane; hangars as huge fortifiable bases.

08 PROGRESSION BETWEEN SESSIONS

Not decided yet. The rule we're aiming for is that progress gives you more options, never more power, so every run stays a real fight and PvP stays fair later.

The leading idea is a persistent **Homestead**: your squad's home hub that lasts forever. You show off trophies there and spend unlocks (new traps, building types, Hometown Hero types, heroes, maps), while every Conquest run starts at the same power level. Weapon upgrades from armories only last for that match.

09 PLATFORM, GRAPHICS & VOICE CHAT

- **PC first,** built in Unreal Engine 5, eventually on Steam. PS5 controllers work on PC. PS5 itself needs approval from Sony's developer program, so that comes later if the game takes off.
- **Graphics:** a stylized look in the spirit of Overwatch and Fortnite, with two graphics modes. Performance mode runs on almost any Windows PC from the last 6–7 years, built-in laptop graphics included (Windows 10, 4-core CPU, 8 GB RAM). Epic mode turns on Unreal 5's full Lumen lighting for gaming PCs (RTX 3060-class). Everyone plays together either way.
- **Voice:** in-game voice chat through Epic Online Services, which is free, including proximity voice so you can hear nearby enemies. Discord works too.
- A rough playable browser prototype already exists for testing ideas. It's not the real game.

10 BUILD ORDER

All the modes share one core (heroes, building, maps, combat, 5-player squads, voice), so each step reuses the last.

1 · CO-OP CONQUEST
On Pine Harbor: the five of us against an AI squad. Builds the whole core and only needs our group.

2 · 5V5 PVP
Swap the AI for another squad of five.

3 · BATTLE ROYALE
More squads, a closing storm, the bigger maps.

4 · HOMESTEAD
The persistent hub tying it all together.

11 OPEN QUESTIONS FOR THE GROUP

- [ ] Progression: is the Homestead plus options-not-power right, or should built bases carry over between runs?
- [ ] Is a 60–90 minute run the right length?
- [ ] Which heroes are missing? Ideas welcome.
- [ ] What does each Pine Harbor sub-base unlock (boats, armories, Hometown Heroes, ...)?
- [ ] Whose PC is the weakest in the squad? It becomes our low-end test machine.
- [ ] Final name: keep "Piney Woods: Timber Wars" or pitch something better.

See y'all in the pines.

Game pitch · October 19, 2026